



Groundhog Decades and Déjà Vu Dystopias – A Looping Parade of Same-Old, Same-Old

Ah, 2023, the year of sci-fi wonders—or so they say. Let's pick apart this parade of movies, shows, and books that apparently stole the spotlight.

Let's dissect these movies a bit more, shall we? "Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 3" might've charmed the masses, but charm can only cover up a lack of originality for so long. And "Transformers: Rise of the Beasts"? Another attempt to squeeze the last drops of nostalgia from a rusting metal franchise. As for "Spider-Man: Across the Spider-Verse," flashy visuals can't mask a story that's

essentially a remix of its predecessor. And don't even get me started on "Rebel Moon: Part One - A Child of Fire" and "The Creator." Rebellion against tyrannical forces and AI dilemmas—been there, done that, got the 'predictable plot' T-shirt.

TV shows weren't exempt from the rinse-and-repeat cycle either. "A Week to Time Travel" probably felt like a Groundhog Day scenario for its viewers. "The Power," "Secret Invasion," "The Last of Us," and "Gotham Knights" sound like a remix playlist of tired tropes, recycled characters, and formulaic plots. Hon-

estly, I wouldn't be surprised if they were all just different shows with the same scripts shuffled around.

And books? Ah, the haven of recycled ideas. Naomi Alderman's dystopia and Christopher Priest's climate fiction—because nothing says 'bestseller' like more doom and gloom. At least they claim to make you think while you're sinking into the same old narrative quicksand.

So, what did 2023 truly offer? A masquerade of innovation, maybe. A facade of creativity, perhaps. But peel back the layers, and what do you find? The same tired themes, regurgitated plots, and an abundance of déjà vu.

You see, when it comes to sci-fi, the bar should be set high. We're talking about a genre where the very essence is pushing boundaries, exploring the unknown, and challenging our perceptions. But nope, not in 2023. It was more like they're playing it safe in a loop of predictability, serving reheated stories that lacked that spark of originality.

The studios and authors seemed content to play it safe, recycling what's worked in the past instead of taking risks. And why bother when the formula seems to print money? But here's the kicker—originality pays off too. Look at the true trailblazers in sci-fi history; they didn't make history by copying the same old script.

It's a shame, really. With all the technological advancements and societal shifts happening, you'd think sci-fi creators would tap into that potential. Imagine the possibilities! Yet, 2023 felt more like a trip down memory lane, a rerun of what we've seen a thousand times before.

But hey, 2024 might surprise us, right? Here's hoping they break the cycle, throw us a curveball, and give us something that'll truly make us sit up and take notice.

Because if it's another year of recycled ideas, I might just have to invent my own time machine to escape this loop of insanity.

—Boo-Man